

# Gum tree

*Gum tree leaves are poisonous to many animals, but koalas eat nothing else!*



Australia is a huge island, with many plants and animals found nowhere else. Gum trees, also called eucalyptus (yoo-ka-lip-tuss), are a common sight. They have long, silvery leaves that are very tough. The leaves are filled with strong-smelling oil that stops most animals from eating them. The oil fills the air and can even make it look blue when the sun is shining. The blue cloud of oil around the gum trees covering the Blue Mountains in eastern Australia give them their name.

Gum trees have colourful flowers, which look like hairy tassels. The flowers turn into cup-shaped gumnuts that contain the tree's seeds. The seeds are released as the nuts dry and turn from green to brown.